

Praveen Kothapally

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Technology Governance & Transformation Leader with 22+ years across banking, financial services, and insurance. Expertise connecting technology delivery with ISO 27001, ICIF, PCI, third-party risk, evidence management, audit response, and remediation tracking. Hands-on AI practitioner building production-ready GRC prototypes. Certified PMP, SAFe 6 Agilist, AWS Cloud Practitioner, and Scrum Master.

CORE COMPETENCIES

ISO 27001 · Technology Risk · Audit & Compliance · GRC · Regulatory Readiness · Third-Party Risk · Evidence Management · AI Governance

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Program Manager — Technology Delivery, Governance and Compliance

Travelex Insurance Services (Zurich Insurance Group / Cover-More Group) | Remote, MN | Dec 2023 - Present

- Coordinate delivery across engineering, QA, business analysis, infrastructure, operations, and business stakeholders.
- Support ISO 27001, internal-control, PCI, and third-party risk initiatives through evidence coordination, ownership tracking, and audit response.
- Improve cross-functional delivery governance, accountability, and executive visibility.
- Explore AI-enabled approaches to governance documentation, evidence management, and delivery operations.
- Spearheaded Third-Party Risk Management (TPRM) process implementation with cross-functional stakeholders.
- Lead release governance across planning, readiness, deployment coordination, production validation, and closure.
- Coach multiple delivery teams in planning, dependency management, continuous improvement, and predictable execution.

- Manage sanction screening governance including rollout support, production monitoring, and file cadence oversight.
- Develop release runbooks, deployment plans, validation standards, release calendars, and leadership communications.
- Built and maintain centralized evidence repositories in Confluence and SharePoint, improving audit response efficiency.
- Develop control traceability across RACE, Zurich control frameworks, and internal implementation activities.
- Coordinate evidence collection, action-item follow-up, and meeting preparation for audit, risk, and compliance reviews.
- Received the Care and Collaboration Award for outstanding contributions in audit and compliance improvements.

Vice President — Technology Manager / Scrum Master

Bank of the West / BNP Paribas | Omaha, NE | Oct 2018 - Dec 2023

- Led enterprise technology upgrade and transformation programs across retail banking operations.
- Managed global teams, vendors, software delivery risk, and cross-functional execution.
- Delivered ~20% delivery productivity improvement through Agile transformation and process redesign.
- Reduced manual testing ~70% through automation engineering and DevOps practices.
- Delivered documented savings exceeding \$250K through automation and operating-model improvements.
- Created project delivery and maturity roadmaps across UI, API, and database layers aligned with strategic objectives.
- Established quality, release, and delivery controls for critical banking platforms.
- Led globally co-located teams to execute short-term and long-term projects, fostering innovation and high performance.
- Spearheaded seamless delivery of multi-million-dollar technology upgrades across all branches as trusted SME.

Associate Vice President — Senior Lead Quality Assurance

Bank of the West / BNP Paribas | Omaha, NE | Dec 2017 - Oct 2018

- Led 15-member geographically distributed QA team supporting critical core banking

initiatives.

- Developed CI/CD-based automation frameworks for cross-browser, API, and mainframe legacy applications.
- Delivered zero-defect releases saving \$200,000; designed automation solutions saving 200+ hours.
- Promoted BDD and TDD best practices across delivery teams.
- Used Agile practices: Daily Stand-ups, Sprint Planning, Prioritized backlogs, Retrospectives, and MVPs.

Senior QA Consultant — Global Banking CRM

Bank of the West / BNP Paribas | San Ramon, CA | Dec 2015 - Dec 2017

- Served as Scrum Master and Senior QA consultant on core banking and CRM transformation projects.
- Single-handedly designed and managed critical automation initiative contributing to zero-defect releases with \$250,000 savings.
- Used PL/SQL, HP UFT, HP ALM, Jira, Confluence, and Xray to strengthen quality engineering.
- Led Scrum Ceremonies and maintained velocity for the projects.

Technology Leadership — Quality Engineering, Program Management

Apple, American Express, First Tech FCU, Infosys, Accenture | Various, US & India | 2002 - 2018

- Implemented scalable test automation and delivery-governance practices across CRM, banking, data, and enterprise applications.
- Led distributed technology and quality teams across onsite and offshore delivery models.
- Progressed through quality engineering, automation, consulting, test management, and process-transformation roles.
- Delivered zero-defect releases for core banking applications saving \$200,000+ per engagement.
- Built QA gating processes and implemented Agile methodologies across sales CRM at Apple.
- Managed QA teams at both onsite and offshore to deliver large releases with boundary teams.
- Established fast-paced agile process and streamlined testing workflows at American Express.
- Implemented Kanban approach in leading enterprise-solutions team at First Tech Federal Credit Union.

AssureCore — AI-Enabled GRC Platform

- Built a working AI-enabled governance, risk, and compliance platform with 35+ regulatory and industry frameworks.
- Includes AI-assisted workflows for compliance documentation, control mapping, and evidence management.
- Designed around operational challenges of managing controls, evidence, risks, assessments, and audit readiness.
- Live demonstration available at praveenkay.me.

UnderwriterAI — Multi-Agent Insurance Prototype

- Designed a multi-agent insurance prototype to assist with policy interpretation, routine underwriting decisions, broker support, and consistent decision-making.
- Bridges domain expertise in insurance delivery with applied AI product thinking. View on [GitHub](#).

AgentVerse — AI Governance Orchestration Framework

- Designed an experimental orchestration framework exploring how specialist AI agents can support governance reporting, audit documentation, evidence preparation, and operational workflows.
- AI applied to governance and delivery workflows grounded in real operational experience. View on [GitHub](#).

Delivery & Quality Tools

- Built a collection of working tools for test management, Jira governance, workflow automation, documentation, and delivery visibility.
- Built using Python, TypeScript, Flask, and Jira APIs. Tools directly support release governance and QA maturity. View on [GitHub](#).

GOVERNANCE & COMPLIANCE EXPERTISE

My differentiator is the ability to work across both delivery and governance — embedding ownership, evidence, and repeatable controls into day-to-day technology operations.

- ISO 27001 audit readiness and coordination
- Internal technology controls and ICIF control coordination
- PCI assessment support
- Evidence management and centralized repositories
- Control ownership and traceability
- Risk identification and remediation tracking
- Third-party technology risk governance (TPRM)

CERTIFICATIONS

- PMP® — Project Management Institute (2021)
- SAgile® 6 Agilist — Scaled Agile (2023)
- AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (2024)
- Scrum Master Accredited Certification (2020)
- AZ-400 Designing and Implementing Microsoft DevOps Solutions

EDUCATION

B.E. Electrical & Electronics Engineering — Bangalore University

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Agile & Quality: Scrum, Kanban, SAgile, Quality Engineering, Automation, CI/CD, Continuous Improvement

Compliance & Audit: ISO 27001, SOC 2 Type II, ICIF, PCI, Third-Party Risk, GDPR, Data Privacy, Control Evidence, Audit Response, Remediation Tracking

Technology & AI: AI Governance, Python, TypeScript, AWS, Docker, Jira, Confluence, SharePoint, ServiceNow GRC, Splunk, GenAI, Prompt Engineering, Multi-Agent Systems

Delivery Leadership: Program Management, Release Governance, Stakeholder Management, Vendor Management, Portfolio Coordination